PLAYFUL FUNCTIONALITY

Is your living room suffering from a mid-life crisis between soulless Pinterest-copied design and online-shopping clutter? It's time to stop choosing between a museum and a mess. Enter the IKEA PS 2026 collection, the design world's equivalent of a cheeky wink in a room full of serious stares. While the rest of the industry is busy arguing over beige vs greige, IKEA is bringing back the 'twinkle in the eye'.

The Dopamine Balance

Maria O'Brien, a 13-year IKEA veteran and the creative lead behind the range, describes the collection as a delicate balancing act. "The challenge was to make something that felt simple and elegant, but had that releaser of dopamine, a smile or a moment of joy," explains O'Brien. This is evident in pieces like the periscope clock and vases with ears, sophisticated enough for a dinner party, but quirky enough to make you grin every time you check the time or freshen the flowers.

High-Tech Laboratory

For IKEA, the PS line isn't just a limited collection; it's a high-tech laboratory. "The innovations tested here, such as advanced wood-bending techniques for benches and solid wood back panelling for wardrobes," shares designer Mikael Axelsson. These breakthroughs are slated to migrate into the core IKEA catalogue over the next five years.

Design with a Human Touch

Despite the heavy R&D, the collection celebrates craftsmanship. Highlights include a handwoven pine cabinet inspired by traditional boat building and a plywood chair that serves as a love letter to tactile materials in an era of mass-produced plastic. Designer Lex Pott emphasises that this physical interaction is crucial, especially for small-space living. His versatile lamp, for instance, requires intuitive rotation to switch between an uplight, spotlight or reading light. "The physical interaction

